# QUINE AND STRAWSON

**PRINTED OWNERSHIP → QUINE DOGMA 1 → QUINE DOGMA 2/HOLISM → REVISION CONSTRAINTS → STRAWSON IDENTIFICATION → BASIC BODIES → PERSON AS PRIMITIVE → DUALISM/NO-OWNERSHIP → BOUNDED ENRICHMENT**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

## 00 STAGE 00 — ONE HEADING, TWO PROJECTS: WHAT THE CLAUSE ACTUALLY ASKS

ONE CLAUSE, TWO PROJECTS | QUINE REFORMS THE EPISTEMOLOGY | STRAWSON REJECTS THE GIVEN | NINE OWNED PYQ PARTS 2018-2025 | NOT A UNITED FRONT: 1956 CLASH

**START → the clause reads: Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic Particulars and Persons.**

**TARGET → classical and logical empiricism, attacked at two different levels.**

→ QUINE 1908-2000 STRAWSON 1919-2006 → **'Two Dogmas of Empiricism' 1951 'Individuals' 1959**

### THE SHARED TARGET

- Classical and logical empiricism is the one enemy both philosophers attack.
- Quine's opponent is the epistemology of individual confirmation.
- Strawson's opponent is the private, momentary sense-datum as the given.

### THE TWO CRITIQUES

- Quine dismantles analyticity and reductionism, then installs confirmation holism.
- Strawson shows identification presupposes a public spatio-temporal framework.
- Grice and Strawson defend in 1956 the very dogma Quine attacked in 1951.

### THE EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Name the owner-thinker before writing: dogmas and holism are Quine's.
- Person, basic particulars and spatio-temporal thinking are Strawson's.
- Only a bare 'critique of empiricism' stem obliges both names together.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Classical and logical empiricism -> attacked at two different levels -> Quine reforms the theory of confirmation -> Strawson rejects the private given -> two verdicts that converge in temper but not in doctrine.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine owns critique of empiricism; Strawson owns basic particulars and persons. They do not form one positive doctrine.**

## 01 STAGE 01 — DOGMA ONE: THE CIRCLE OF SYNONYMY

ANALYTIC / SYNTHETIC DISTINCTION | CIRCLE OF SYNONYMY | SALVA VERITATE NEEDS NECESSITY | SEMANTIC RULES ONLY GIVE ANALYTIC-IN-L | DEGREE, NOT KIND | NOT: ANALYTIC TRUTHS DO NOT EXIST

**CLAIM UNDER TEST → there is a principled line between analytic and synthetic truth.**

→ ANALYTIC → true by virtue of MEANING → MEANING → requires SYNONYMY → **DEFINITION → only RECORDS an antecedent synonymy → CIRCULAR** → **INTERCHANGEABILITY salva veritate needs NECESSITY, a cognate of analyticity → CIRCULAR extensional counter-case: creature with**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CLAIM UNDER TEST → there is a principled line between analytic and synthetic truth.
- ANALYTIC → true by virtue of MEANING
- MEANING → requires SYNONYMY
- DEFINITION → only RECORDS an antecedent synonymy → CIRCULAR

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- INTERCHANGEABILITY salva veritate needs NECESSITY, a cognate of analyticity → CIRCULAR extensional counter-case: creature with a heart / with a kidney
- SEMANTIC RULES (Carnap) → defined via 'analytic-in-L' → CIRCULAR
- OUTCOME → no principled, non-circular criterion of analyticity.
- EXACT CONCLUSION → a difference of DEGREE (centrality), not of KIND.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- OBJECTION → Grice and Strawson 1956: a usable distinction needs no definition.
- REPLY → usability is not theoretical legitimacy; compare witch / non-witch.
- PROVENANCE → Philosophical Review, January 1951; revised 1953.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Analytic -> meaning -> synonymy -> definition or interchangeability salva veritate or semantic rules -> each route presupposes analyticity -> the criterion is circular.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Definitions, synonymy and interchangeability fail to explain the sharp analytic boundary; semantical rules classify stipulated languages but leave residue.**

## 02 STAGE 02 — DOGMA TWO AND THE WEB OF BELIEF

REDUCTIONISM REJECTED | CORPORATE BODY, NOT SENTENCE BY SENTENCE | WEB OF BELIEF / FIELD OF FORCE | NO STATEMENT IS IMMUNE | MINIMUM MUTILATION, NOT ANYTHING GOES

**DOGMA 2 → reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.**

**REFUTATION → statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.**

← (o) (o) (o) (o) (o) <- observation sentences at the PERIPHERY → **[ physics, chemistry, biology ] <- revised fairly easily**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DOGMA 2 → reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.
- REFUTATION → statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.
- (o) (o) (o) (o) (o) <- observation sentences at the PERIPHERY
- [ physics, chemistry, biology ] <- revised fairly easily
- [ mathematics ] <- revised rarely

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [ LOGIC ] <- revised last, never immune
- CLASH AT THE EDGE → revise somewhere → the place of revision is CHOSEN.
- option A → adjust a peripheral belief option B → plead hallucination option C → revise a deep interior law
- DOCTRINE 1 → any statement can be held true come what may.
- DOCTRINE 2 → no statement is immune to revision, not even a law of logic.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CONSEQUENCES → no analytic/synthetic line; no a priori/a posteriori line
- theory-choice by simplicity, conservatism, generality, fecundity
- the verification principle loses its application.
- LIMIT → minimum mutilation, Philosophy of Logic 1970, blocks 'anything goes'.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Statements meet experience corporately; revision remains constrained by evidence, prediction, simplicity, conservatism and minimum mutilation.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Confirmation holism replaces individual verification with a web of belief whose interior is protected by choice rather than by immunity, so any sentence may be saved and none is beyond revision, but only at a stated cost elsewhere in the system.**

## 03 STAGE 03 — THE DUHEM-QUINE MACHINERY AND ITS TWO AUTHORS

(H & A) IMPLIES O | MODUS TOLLENS HITS THE CONJUNCTION | NEPTUNE 1846 / VULCAN THEN RELATIVITY 1915 | DUHEM 1906 IS NOT QUINE 1951 | POPPER AND LAKATOS ACCEPT THE LOGIC

| Axis | DUHEM 1906 | QUINE 1951 |
|---|---|---|
| Scope | theoretical physics only | the whole of science |
| Logic & maths | exempt | included; none immune |
| Corollary | no experimentum crucis | underdetermination |

### SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TESTABLE CLAIM → ( H & A ) implies O, where A is background theory and conditions.
- OBSERVATION → NOT-O
- MODUS TOLLENS → NOT ( H & A ) only: H is false OR some element of A is false.
- LOGIC IS SILENT → the conjunct to surrender is not dictated by the evidence.
- RESULT → refutation is never conclusive against a single statement

### DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- DUHEM 1906
- QUINE 1951
- theoretical physics only
- the whole of science
- Logic & maths

### EVALUATION / TRAP

- no experimentum crucis
- CASE 1 → Uranus: revise the auxiliary → NEPTUNE, Le Verrier and Adams, 1846.
- CASE 2 → Mercury: 'VULCAN' fails → revise the deep law → relativity, 1915.
- REPLIES → Popper: falsification is a methodological decision, not pure logic.
- Lakatos: hard core plus revisable protective belt.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** (H and A) implies O -> observation gives not-O -> modus tollens yields not-(H and A) -> logic is silent on the conjunct -> revision is a pragmatic choice -> individual verifiability has no application.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Duhem's physics thesis and Quine's whole-system holism differ; neither makes all repairs equally rational.**

## 04 STAGE 04 — RADICAL TRANSLATION, GAVAGAI AND THE THREE RESULTS

RADICAL TRANSLATION | ONE STIMULUS MEANING, FIVE READINGS | APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION IN DISPUTE | INSCRUTABILITY THEN INDETERMINACY | CHOMSKY: ONLY UNDERDETERMINATION

**SET-UP → radical translation: no dictionary, no interpreter; evidence is stimulation plus assent or dissent**

**'A rabbit runs past; the native says 'Gavagai'.**

→ **'rabbit' 'undetached 'temporal 'rabbithood' 'it is rabbiting' rabbit- stage of a (universal (feature-placing** → **parts' rabbit' instantiated) no object at all) all share ONE stimulus meaning**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SET-UP → radical translation: no dictionary, no interpreter, evidence is stimulation plus assent or dissent only. Word and Object 1960, ch. 2.
- A rabbit runs past; the native says 'Gavagai'.
- 'rabbit' 'undetached 'temporal 'rabbithood' 'it is rabbiting' rabbit- stage of a (universal (feature-placing
- parts' rabbit' instantiated) no object at all) all share ONE stimulus meaning

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ASK 'some gavagai?' → presupposes the identity predicate, articles, plurals, quantifiers: the APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION in dispute.
- RESULT 1 → INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE: no fact about what the terms refer to.
- RESULT 2 → INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION: rival analytical hypotheses agree on all observation sentences yet differ elsewhere; nothing decides.
- RESULT 3 → ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY: reference only relative to a background manual.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PREMISES → behaviourism about evidence; verificationism about facts; naturalism.
- OBJECTIONS → Chomsky: only underdetermination. Davidson: harmless, scale-like.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** One stimulus meaning -> several rival term-translations -> the identity question presupposes individuation -> reference is inscrutable -> rival manuals agree on all observation sentences -> translation is indeterminate -> reference is theory-relative.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Radical translation, sentence indeterminacy, reference inscrutability and ontological relativity are distinct bounded doctrines.**

## 05 STAGE 05 — QUINE'S POSITIVE SYSTEM AND THE REFORM OF EMPIRICISM

TO BE IS TO BE A BOUND VARIABLE | REGIMENT AND AUDIT THE QUANTIFIERS | NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY 1968/69 | EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS | NOT DATED TO TWO DOGMAS 1951

**QUESTION 1 → what is there?**

**CRITERION → 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What**

→ **METHOD → regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.** → **CONSEQUENCE → commitment is relative to the regimentation → ontological relativity.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- QUESTION 1 → what is there?
- CRITERION → 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What There Is 1948.
- METHOD → regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.
- CONSEQUENCE → commitment is relative to the regimentation → ontological relativity.
- QUESTION 2 → how do we know?

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ANSWER → naturalized epistemology; philosophy continuous with science.
- 'a chapter of psychology', 1968/69; sensory input to theoretical output.
- IMAGE → Neurath's boat: rebuilt plank by plank at sea, never in dry dock.
- QUESTION 3 → what happens to the a priori?
- CHARGE → no non-circular analyticity + universal revisability + no first philosophy + holding a belief a priori is a metaphysical article of faith.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUESTION 4 → is empiricism abandoned?
- ANSWER → no: empiricism WITHOUT the dogmas; experience still governs belief, holistically rather than sentence by sentence.
- BRIDGE → later Wittgenstein converges (museum myth rejected, holism, anti-private) but parts on method: Quine REFORMS by regimentation.
- Wittgenstein DESCRIBES.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Bound-variable commitment follows theory/regimentation choice; naturalization rejects first philosophy but faces a normative objection.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine does not reject empiricism but purifies it: experience still governs belief, yet only holistically, ontology is read off regimented science, and epistemology becomes a chapter of natural science rather than its a priori foundation.**

## 06 STAGE 06 — STRAWSON'S BASIC PARTICULARS AND THE IDENTIFICATION FRAMEWORK

DESCRIPTIVE, NOT REVISIONARY | RE-IDENTIFICATION IS THE HINGE | ONE PUBLIC SPATIO-TEMPORAL FRAMEWORK | MATERIAL BODIES ARE BASIC | AUDITORY WORLD NEEDS A MASTER-SOUND

**METHOD → DESCRIPTIVE metaphysics: describe the scheme we actually use.**

**contrast → REVISIONARY: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley propose a better scheme.**

→ **provenance → Individuals 1959, 'An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics'.** → **DEFINITION → a BASIC PARTICULAR is identifiable without identifying anything else.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- METHOD → DESCRIPTIVE metaphysics: describe the scheme we actually use.
- contrast → REVISIONARY: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley propose a better scheme.
- provenance → Individuals 1959, 'An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics'.
- DEFINITION → a BASIC PARTICULAR is identifiable without identifying anything else.
- ARGUMENT FROM RE-IDENTIFICATION

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 2 re-identification requires ONE unified spatio-temporal system
- 3 material bodies constitute it: three-dimensional, enduring, publicly located
- 4 sounds, events, private experiences are identified only BY reference to bodies
- 5 therefore MATERIAL BODIES are basic; PERSONS are the second basic particular
- STATUS → conceptual dependence, not causal or metaphysical priority.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- MASTER-SOUND whose pitch fixes position → a space-analogue is reintroduced.
- VERDICT → the experiment supports the thesis rather than defeating it.
- OBJECTION → Evans: the construction may smuggle in spatial notions.
- 2020 LINK → spatio-temporal thinking is a precondition of OBJECTIVE thinking.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Objective thought -> requires re-identification -> requires one unified spatio-temporal system -> constituted by material bodies -> everything else is identified through them -> bodies are basic.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Objective identification and re-identification require a public spatio-temporal framework; an auditory scheme needs an analogue of space.**

## 07 STAGE 07 — PERSONS: THE PREDICATE MATRIX AND THE DOUBLE DEMOLITION

PERSON IS LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE | M-PREDICATES AND P-PREDICATES | SELF-ASCRIPTION NEEDS OTHER-ASCRIPTION | BLOCKS DUALISM AND NO-OWNERSHIP | NOT LOGICAL BEHAVIOURISM

| M-PREDICATES | P-PREDICATES also true of mere | states of consciousness and action; only persons material bodies | others by behavioural criteria; self without |
|---|---|---|---|
| 'weighs 70 kg' | observation or criteria → ASYMMETRY | | |

### SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- THESIS → the concept of a PERSON is logically PRIMITIVE; not mind plus body assembled.
- P-PREDICATES also true of mere
- states of consciousness and action; only persons material bodies
- others by behavioural criteria; self without
- 'weighs 70 kg'

### DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- observation or criteria → ASYMMETRY
- 1 (all-ascribe P-predicates (1 am in pain')
- 2 a self-ascribable predicate must be understood as ascribable to others
- 3 other-ascription requires identifying others as single M-and-P subjects
- 4 therefore the person concept is presupposed by self-ascription itself

### EVALUATION / TRAP

- BLOCKS CARTESIAN DUALISM BLOCKS THE NO-OWNERSHIP THEORY two independent substances cannot 'the experiences had by this body' be the ONE subject
- P-predicates covertly restores the ownership it become unlearnable and other minds denies
- Schlick and Lichtenberg's unknowable 'it thinks' is self-refuting
- GUARD → not logical behaviourism: behaviour is criterial evidence, not meaning.
- OBJECTIONS → co-instantiation rather than primitiveness; Ayer on no-ownership.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Self-ascription of P-predicates -> presupposes understanding their other-ascription -> presupposes identifying others as single M-and-P subjects -> the person concept is presupposed -> person is primitive.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Person is conceptually primitive and bears physical and psychological predicates; this undercuts Cartesian priority without positing a third substance.**

## 08 STAGE 08 — REFERENCE, PRESUPPOSITION AND STRAWSON'S OWN ANTI-EMPIRICISM

PEOPLE REFER, SENTENCES MEAN | PRESUPPOSED, NOT ASSERTED | TRUTH-VALUE GAP, NOT FALSITY | FIVE ANTI-EMPIRICIST LINES | DESCRIPTIVE SCOPE IS A REAL LIMIT

| Issue | RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905 | STRAWSON, On Referring |
|---|---|---|
| Who refers | the sentence, by quantifier | people, in a USE |
| Existence | ASSERTED in the analysis | PRESUPPOSED, not asserted |
| Empty term | the statement is FALSE | a TRUTH-VALUE GAP |
| Meaning | truth-conditions of a type | rules for correct use |

### SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TEST SENTENCE → 'The present King of France is bald' (there is no such king).
- RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905
- STRAWSON, On Referring
- Who refers
- the sentence, by quantifier

### DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Empty term
- the statement is FALSE
- a TRUTH-VALUE GAP
- truth-conditions of a type
- rules for correct use

### EVALUATION / TRAP

- 2 bundle and no-ownership selves collapse → person is primitive [Individuals 3]
- 3 reference abstracted from use is a mistake [On Referring]
- 4 the global demand to justify induction is senseless [Logical Theory 1952]
- 5 objectivity needs a framework not drawn from experience [Bounds of Sense 1966]
- FORM → take an undisputed fact, ask its conditions, show the empiricist materials fail.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Presupposition failure concerns a use/assertion, not sentence meaning; Russell and later presupposition theories retain separate ownership.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sentences do not refer, people refer in a use on an occasion, so existence is presupposed rather than asserted and reference-failure produces a truth-value gap; the same anti-atomism makes the given public rather than private.**

## 09 STAGE 09 — CONFRONTATION, CONVERGENCE AND THE REUSABLE ANSWER SPINE

REVISABLE THEORY OR PRESUPPOSED FRAME | METHOD MIRRORS DOCTRINE | ANTI-CARTESIAN PUBLIC ANCHOR | LAYERED VERDICT, NOT A WINNER | THEY BASICALLY AGREE IS A TRAP

**descriptive metaphysics** → **revisable come what may** → **core is indispensable** → **behavioural, indeterminate** → **fixed by public criteria**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- descriptive metaphysics
- revisable come what may
- core is indispensable
- behavioural, indeterminate
- fixed by public criteria

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- the public spatio-temporal
- CONVERGENCES → anti-Cartesian about a private inner object
- the public and structured replaces the atomic and private
- the museum myth of determinate private meanings is rejected by both.
- DO NOT OVERSTATE → they differ on status, meaning and method; 'they basically agree' is the standing trap on comparative stems.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ANSWER SPINE → 1 decode the directive and name the owner-thinker
- 2 thesis in one line
- 3 mechanism with the exact term
- 4 objection and reply, objector named
- 5 graded verdict with a provenance-clean date

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Two critiques of one target -> opposite views of the scheme's status -> mirrored methods -> genuine convergences in temper -> a layered verdict on revisability.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kant, reactive attitudes, translation and ontology are bounded; all nine PYQs route through Two Dogmas, basic particulars or persons.**

## E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | ADVANCED SESSION 1 — TWO-PROJECT MAP - ONE SYLLABUS | ADVANCED SESSION 2 — QUINE, DOGMA 1 - THE | ADVANCED SESSION 3 — QUINE, DOGMA 2 AND THE | ADVANCED SESSION 4 — THE DUHEM-QUINE THESIS - WHY | ADVANCED SESSION 5 — RADICAL TRANSLATION AND 'GAVAGAI' | ADVANCED SESSION 6 — ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT, NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY AND | ADVANCED SESSION 7 — STRAWSON'S BASIC PARTICULARS - MATERIAL

### OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Two-Project Map - One Syllabus Heading, Two Philosophers, Two Different Critiques of Empiricism
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Quine, Dogma 1 - The Analytic/Synthetic Distinction and the Circle of Synonymy
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Quine, Dogma 2 and the Positive Doctrine - Reductionism Rejected, Confirmation Holism and the Web of Belief
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — The Duhem-Quine Thesis - Why No Single Hypothesis Faces Experience Alone

### ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Radical Translation and 'Gavagai' - Inscrutability of Reference and Indeterminacy of Translation
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Ontological Commitment, Naturalized Epistemology and Ontological Relativity - and Quine's Convergence with the Later Wittgenstein
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Strawson's Basic Particulars - Material Bodies and the Single Spatio-Temporal Framework
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Strawson's Persons - The Primitive Concept, M/P-Predicates, and the Block on Dualism

### COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — 'On Referring' versus Russell, and Strawson as a Critic of Empiricism
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Synthesis - Quine versus Strawson, Their Convergences, and the Universal Answer Spine
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- The shared item is a target , not a shared thesis.

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels